

RE: San Mateo ALPR data retained at NCRIC – publicly posted vendor code



From Ed Barberini <ebarberini@cityofsanmateo.org>
To Brian C <[REDACTED]>
Cc Bahareh Abdollahi <babdollahi@cityofsanmateo.org>
Date 2026-09-17 23:48

Hi Brian,

Thank you for bringing this matter to our attention. We raised these concerns with NCRIC and received the following response from NCRIC Assistant Deputy Director Brian Rodriguez regarding the issue:

In brief summary: an engineer from a now-closed company that NCRIC previously worked with in 2022 and 2023, posted his work publicly on the code repository site Github, which unfortunately contained sensitive content including an audit log with six months of officer queries, and ALPR device names potentially revealing their locations; details which typically would be redacted or exempt from public release. Efforts are underway with Github to have this taken down, and direct outreach has been attempted with the individual. Further review is still occurring, but fortunately I’ve yet to uncover any evidence that raw public ALPR reads have been retained or were compromised. Note that, since 2024, NCRIC is not involved in any data collection or replication efforts, for ALPR or any other records, from any other agencies, including San Mateo PD.

- Whether historical SMPD ALPR data remains stored within any NCRIC system or database and, if so, the applicable retention period and current disposition of that data.
NCRIC is not in possession of any repositories of ALPR data from any agency, including San Mateo Police Department
- Whether SMPD ALPR data was replicated or stored outside of the originating Flock system and whether searches of that data are separately audited.
Prior to 2024, NCRIC strove to unify ALPR data across vendor and agency jurisdictions, and to provide law enforcement with access to the unified dataset. This included replication and/or federation of data from the original vendor location, such as Flock. All searches of the data were logged for audit purposes.
- Whether NCRIC is aware of source code, configuration information, audit logs, ALPR data, or other operational information having been publicly disclosed or made accessible by a current or former NCRIC vendor.
Yes, NCRIC is aware of the public posting of content, including audit logs, screenshots, ALPR locations, by an employee of a vendor the NCRIC previously worked with in 2022 and 2023.
- Whether any publicly accessible information includes SMPD data, user information, search activity, case information, license plate information, or underlying ALPR records.
An audit log file spanning June – November 2023 contains six entries of queries by San Mateo Police Department, including the officer’s email address, plate searched, and associated case number.
- The identity and current status of the vendor involved and whether that vendor, or any successor or third party, currently possesses copies of SMPD-contributed data.
NCRIC did not renew its contract with Maiveric when it concluded in December 2023. There was no transition to a successor or other third party. It is the understanding of the NCRIC that Maiveric is no longer in business.
- What steps NCRIC has taken, or is taking, to assess and address any potential exposure and to ensure that agency data held by NCRIC or its vendors is appropriately secured or deleted.
NCRIC continues to review the data contained in the repository on Github and continues to pursue takedown measures of the content. Other previous initiatives that used local databases residing in the NCRIC datacenter have been confirmed to be properly erased or destroyed.
- The process available to a member agency under the NCRIC MOU to request withdrawal and deletion of previously contributed data, including replicated copies, and whether such a request is necessary when an agency has already discontinued sharing.
Since the conclusion of the contract with Maiveric in December 2023, NCRIC is not in possession of any ALPR records from other agencies. Similarly, other law enforcement data sharing initiatives such as Coplink are no longer active and/or no longer leveraging NCRIC for data services, and all records have been purged.
- If NCRIC has conducted an internal review or has prepared any notification, assessment, technical explanation, or other documentation addressing these issues, please provide that information as well.
NCRIC is preparing additional notification and outreach to similarly impacted partner agencies.

At the time the queries referenced in your inquiry were conducted, San Mateo Police Department personnel had authorized access to the ALPR database through NCRIC for legitimate law enforcement purposes and in support of ongoing investigations.

The information you brought to our attention appears to originate from NCRIC system audit logs that were made publicly available by a former NCRIC employee. These logs appear to document user search activity within the NCRIC system, similar to audit information that may be made publicly available through law enforcement transparency portals.

At this time, we are not aware of any San Mateo Police Department ALPR camera-read data being inappropriately shared or made available on the public site in question. Rather, the information appears to reflect audit records of user activity within the NCRIC system and does not appear to include or represent ALPR camera-read data belonging to the San Mateo Police Department.

It is also important to note that, effective May 19, 2026, the San Mateo Police Department terminated its data-sharing relationship with NCRIC and discontinued access to the NCRIC ALPR system.

Because this matter involves NCRIC systems, its former vendor, and NCRIC’s ongoing review and response to the public disclosure, we respectfully ask that any additional inquiries regarding this matter be directed to NCRIC, as they are best positioned to provide the most current and complete information regarding their systems, records, and response efforts.

Ed

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-----Original Message-----

From: Brian C <[REDACTED]>
Sent: Friday, September 11, 2026 10:54 PM
To: Ed Barberini <ebarberini@cityofsanmateo.org>
Subject: San Mateo ALPR data retained at NCRIC – publicly posted vendor code

Chief Barberini,

I just wanted to write to you to flag something new affecting the city, that you may not have been made aware of.

Until recently, SMPD has shared ALPR data with NCRIC. SMPD's own SOP 205 says the department "partner[s] with the NCRIC to store the ALPR data we collect with PIPs and Flock." Since February, a vendor contracted by NCRIC has made public the software infrastructure code (it was posted by an engineer of the company, not leaked). It's still up today, and multiple other people have made their own copies of it since late August, rendering it effectively permanently public.

The code that was published documents an automated process that fetches each participating agency's previous day's plate data, and stored it into a separate NCRIC database, with no expiration or purge setting enabled in the published configuration. The system contains 341 datasets, including a separate ALPR dataset for each contributing agency. None of them has an expiration or purge value set. Because that copy sits outside Flock, searches against it would not appear in the department's Flock audit logs.

TLDR: Every license plate read that san mateo recorded from at least mid-2023 until the department stopped sharing with NCRIC appears to remain in NCRIC's system (despite the department's 30-day flock retention settings), and is not set to expire or purge.

The vendor that operated the platform seems to no longer be in business, and that vendor also appears to retain copies of agency data, as well. It has additionally made public audit logs and other operational records from NCRIC's system, including San Mateo Police Department's search records (without any redactions).

Section 6 of the department's MOU with NCRIC provides that member agencies "remain the official custodian of all information contributed to the NCRIC–DSP." I would be very interested to know how the department has acted to protect its citizens' data at both another remote agency (NCRIC), and a now defunct private business. I had previously filed a PRA (W012376) asking for any records of the department restricting NCRIC's re-sharing of San Mateo ALPR data -- and the "no responsive records" to that request indicates that the department didn't even take the basic measure to protect its residents as the NCRIC MOU outlines.

The MOU's Data Sharing section says data a member agency later declares should not be shared "shall be withdrawn by all Hosts from all NCRIC–DSP Systems within 48 hours, including deletion of any replications of the data" -- a step the department has produced no record of taking.

Separately, the published files include an export of NCRIC's search audit log. As an example of what's readable right now: on September 11, 2023, account [REDACTED] ran three queries under case [REDACTED], searching for plate numbers [REDACTED], [REDACTED] and [REDACTED].

As the official custodian of this data, what specific actions is the department taking to protect our residents' privacy? In particular, I would like to know whether it intends to make the declaration to NCRIC described above, what the department has done to assess the exposure of the data already published, and what became of the copies held by a now-defunct software vendor.

I would appreciate a response ahead of the October council discussion of the department's Flock program -- ideally within the next week, so that I can take the department's position into account.

–brian

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